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Culture (OWC): [San \(FX10\)](#)

Region: Africa

Sub Region: Southern Africa

Field Date: 1973-1975

Coverage Date: 1973-1975

Place Coverage: /Ai/Ai And Environs, Northwest Botswana

Section Title(S): Affinal Xin

Terms are not fixed for individuals in this category and are applied first by the homonymous method and if by any chance they can't be fit into that, by the generational one. Marshall's third group is spouses of secondary affines who are given terms which, as will be discussed later, place them into the same joking position as their spouse. Degree of contact with affines, primary or secondary is highly variable and depends much on how well two families get along, their location, etc.. It is not unusual for two camps to join upon marriage nor is it unusual for an individual to return with his spouse to his n!ori and rarely see his affines.

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Fixed terms for primary relatives are rather straight forward and learned, terms applied according to the homonymous method are determined by the older of the two. All terms have a reciprocal and so once addressed the younger knows with which term to respond. Homonymous terms are not always so clear—one can have several relatives sharing the same name—and people seem to enjoy negotiating which terms should be used. In [114](#) addition, kin terms can change over their lifetime with marriage or change of name. Since a person learns what term to use for an elder in any relationship other than primary fixed ones, by using the reciprocal of that the elder uses for him, he may never be aware of the exact genealogical relationship behind the term. The existence of a relationship with a known term can be passed on for generations after the original relation is forgotten.

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